

Programme Improvement Plan

IndiaFOSS 2027 — How to Build On This Year. A companion to the IndiaFOSS 2026 Programme Analysis — concrete, numbers-driven ideas for next year's Call for Proposals, venue planning, and community outreach.

This is an internal planning document, generated by an AI assistant (Claude), not an official FOSS United / IndiaFOSS publication. Built on the same public dataset as the main programme analysis (sessions, booths, sponsors, general knowledge of India's FOSS landscape), plus a public list of 324 rejected CFP submissions used in Section 2 — provided directly as a file by the organiser, the same convenience as cfp-info.csv in the main report, rather than fetched by this session from IndiaFOSS's own CFP dashboard (an authenticated organiser view, which was not used here). The devroom attribution in Section 2 is this report's own estimate from titles — that field isn't in the original data — so it should be checked against the actual devroom managers' sense of their own rejects before anyone acts on it. Workshop, room-count and reach figures throughout are planning estimates, not commitments.

38

CANDIDATE NEW
WORKSHOPS

10–18

ROOMS NEEDED, BY TIER

3

DEVROOMS MOST
NEEDING ROOM

12+

COMMUNITIES WORTH
INVITING

Prepared as a follow-up to if2026-summary.pdf, using the same session/booth/sponsor dataset — including this edition's new per-session **reach** figure (seat capacity of the room each session runs in) — plus reasoning grounded in general knowledge of India's FOSS community landscape. See the note on data sources at the end of each section.

Executive Summary

IndiaFOSS 2026 was diagnosed as strong on embedded-systems depth, community culture, and an unusually dense "producer" ratio — but thin on hands-on workshops for its deepest tracks, short several devrooms (Data, Policy, Telecom, Creative-Experience) that were proposed and not selected purely on capacity grounds, and — this edition's addition — structurally capped in **reach**: every devroom session, no matter how deep or oversubscribed, runs in a room no bigger than 120 seats, while the General Track reaches up to 840. This companion report turns those findings into four concrete moves for 2027:

- 1. **Turn producers into workshop leads.** Every devroom, a meaningful slice of the booth floor, and 14 already-written proposals that were rejected purely for lack of room together give 38 concrete candidates by name — no new pitching required for at least 22 of them.
- 2. **Give Hardware, Cloud & DevOps, and Security more room next year.** All three rejected an estimated ~68–77% of their submissions this year, by far the tightest of the 8 devrooms — and all three are stuck at the same 120-seat reach ceiling as AOSP, this year's least oversubscribed devroom. AOSP, by contrast, accepted most of what it received and needs outreach more than space.
- 3. **Plan the venue math for folding workshops (and a third, busier BoF room) into the two conference days** instead of a separate pre-conference day, under the newly-widened seat-capacity ranges — three tiers, a 10-room pilot up to an 18-room full ambition — including a third devroom room and the newly-allowed full-day slot that finally let Hardware, Cloud & DevOps and Security each get the genuinely longer slot Section 2 identifies them as needing — and combine it with the new booth/sponsor caps to size 2027 for an estimated **~3,105 total attendees, all categories included** (Section 3), now that this year's own documentation confirms purchased tickets and reserved producer passes are non-overlapping categories.
- 4. **Invite named communities** that map directly onto this year's gaps and could plausibly run a devroom as a mini-conference version of their own yearly event.

1. Turning producers into workshop leads

This year's 8 pre-conference workshops came entirely from individual proposals — none from the devrooms or the 75-booth community floor, even though both groups clearly have the hands-on expertise (the booth floor alone runs 6 hardware-focused tables and several teaching-oriented projects). If IndiaFOSS asked each devroom for one workshop, and invited a subset of technically hands-on booths to do the same, here's a concrete, named starting list — proposals for the organising team to pitch to these specific groups, not commitments they've made.

1a. One workshop per devroom (8)

Devroom	Candidate workshop	Why this devroom can run it
RTOS	Flash & debug Zephyr on real hardware	Directly closes the sharpest gap this year's analysis found — the deepest devroom (7.4/10) has zero hands-on time.
AOSP	Build & flash a custom AOSP image	11 sessions already cover bring-up, HALs and bootloaders in depth.
Compilers	Write your first LLVM pass	Run by LLVM Social Bangalore — a standing community, not a one-off organiser.
Hardware	PCB design & soldering 101	Run by absurd.industries, who already staff a hardware booth and could combine both roles.
Security	Userspace sandboxing / binary RE walkthrough	Highest average depth (6.8/10) outside RTOS; strong practical case studies already exist.
Cloud & DevOps	Kubernetes observability with Perses/Prometheus	Run by Point Blank, who also handle much of the event's own on-ground infra.
Documentation & Technical Writing	Docs-as-code: ship a living documentation pipeline	11 sessions of practitioner experience, currently talk-only.
Design	Build a design system from scratch	Zero lightning talks this year — this devroom already favours depth over breadth.

1b. Sixteen booth-sourced candidates

Picked from the 75-booth floor for having a teachable tool or process, not just an awareness message:

Booth / project	Candidate workshop
CircuitVerse	Digital logic design with CircuitVerse
Jupyter	Building interactive notebooks & extensions
SciPy India	Scientific computing with NumPy/SciPy
FOSSEE	Teaching with Scilab/Python: an educator's workshop
FreeBSD Project	Getting started with FreeBSD
Debian	Packaging for Debian: your first package
F-Droid	Publish your first app on F-Droid
GOSH (Open Science Hardware)	Open science hardware build session
Ampere Works	Electronics prototyping 101
T-01 The Explorer	Build a mini robot
Xeneva	OS development fundamentals
Rethink DNS + Firewall	Build your own network privacy tool
Bahmni	Configuring a health facility in Bahmni
webminal.org	Linux terminal bootcamp
Idlistack (Tech4Good)	Deploy your first app on an open PaaS
Data For India / OpenCity / Samaajdata (joint)	Civic data wrangling workshop

That last one is worth flagging on its own: a joint civic-data workshop run by three booths that already do this work daily would be a direct, low-risk way to partially answer the rejected "Building with Open Data in India" devroom pitch without waiting for a full devroom slot.

1c. The lowest-effort path: 14 workshops already exist, rejected only for lack of room

The organiser-supplied rejected-proposals list shows 14 Workshop-type proposals were submitted this year and turned down — not for lack of interest, but presumably because the pre-conference day had no more room. Re-inviting these authors for 2027 is far lower-effort than the speculative lists above, and several land squarely on gaps this report and the main analysis already flagged:

- Mastering Firmware Testing with Renode: From Unit Testing to CI/CD with Code Coverage — directly extends the RTOS devroom into hands-on territory, the single sharpest gap in the main report.
- Beyond Emulation: Hardware-in-the-Loop Testing on Shared Remote Boards — same RTOS/embedded gap, a second independent pitch at it.
- Mindful App Installation with F-Droid — matches the F-Droid booth candidate in 1b almost exactly; this one already has a committed author.
- How did we write an Operating System from scratch? Learn & experience XenevaOS — matches the Xeneva booth candidate in 1b; again, an author already stepped forward.
- Adding roads and buildings to OpenStreetMap (indoor workshop) — a second, complementary OSM workshop alongside this year's outdoor one.
- Hands-on usage of CoRE stack datasets and APIs for social-ecological planning — a hands-on companion to this year's accepted CoRE Stack talk.
- Recipes and Runtimes: Making Sense of Containers in 2026, Using AI with K3s and Kubectrl, Building Agentic AI Systems with Small Language Models — three separate Cloud/AI-infrastructure workshop pitches, reinforcing how much unmet AI-tooling appetite exists (the main report finds AI-related content scattered across five tracks with no home, Section 6).

The remaining rejected workshops (contributor-experience design thinking, a Qt-based Mankala game engine, an SDLC coding-agent workshop) are lower-priority but still real, ready-to-run submissions.

The headline number. 8 devroom-sourced + 16 booth-sourced + 14 already-submitted-and-rejected = 38 candidate workshops (with some overlap between the booth and already-rejected lists — F-Droid and Xeneva appear in both), on top of the 8 that already ran. Even a conservative conversion — say the 14 real submissions plus half the speculative 24 — is a workshop day roughly three times this year's size, which is exactly the venue-planning question Section 3 works through.

1d. Encouraging producers to run BoFs too

This year's BoF pool was small and not very oversubscribed: 14 formal submissions (11 accepted, 3 rejected — a ~79% acceptance rate, per the organiser-supplied rejected-proposals list), covering topics like cooperatives, micro-granting, and community governance. A BoF is a much lower-effort ask than a workshop — no slides, no curriculum, just a room and a topic — so it's a natural second lever for turning producers into active participants rather than passive presenters.

Devrooms (8): each could run an informal town-hall alongside its regular sessions — e.g. "AOSP Roadmap: What's Next", "RTOS Practitioners Meetup", "Compiler Toolchain Roundtable" — one per devroom, mirroring the workshop-per-devroom idea in 1a.

Booths — the "Community" category is the natural source (12 candidates): FOSS United Mangalore, COSH NITK, SciPy India, FOSS4G.IN, Wikimedians of Kerala, Open Data Kerala, XMPP Standards Foundation, TinkerSpace, Homebrew at HSP, OASIS, GOSH, and Future of the Commons — all already community-facing rather than pure product demos, and a BoF is closer to what they're already doing at their table than a workshop would be.

The BoF headline number. 8 devroom-sourced + 12 booth-sourced = 20 candidate new BoFs, against this year's 11 accepted — call it roughly a tripling of BoF volume if even most convert. Section 3's room count folds in a dedicated third BoF room to absorb this.

2. Should any devroom get a longer slot?

The organiser supplied the full list of 324 rejected CFP submissions separately (title, session type, and status — no track field). That list doesn't say which devroom each rejected talk was aimed at, so this section estimates it by matching each rejected title's vocabulary against the themes of this year's accepted sessions in each devroom (e.g. a rejected title mentioning "Kubernetes" or "observability" is counted toward Cloud & DevOps). This is title-only keyword matching with no description text to check it against, so treat every number below as directionally useful, not exact — a proper pass would have the actual devroom managers sort their own rejects.

Devroom	Accepted	Est. rejected	Est. acceptance rate	Reading
Hardware	6	~20	~23%	Strongest case for more room — rejected 3 of every 4 estimated submissions.
Cloud & DevOps	10	~32	~24%	Strongest case for more room — by far the most estimated submissions of any devroom.
Security	9	~19	~32%	Secondary candidate — meaningfully oversubscribed.
Compilers	11	~10	~52%	Moderately subscribed; current slot looks about right.
Documentation & Technical Writing	11	~10	~52%	Moderately subscribed; current slot looks about right.
RTOS	10	~8	~56%	Comfortably subscribed, despite running the deepest content (7.4/10) — its gap is the missing workshop (Section 1), not slot length.
Design	7	~4	~64%	Comfortably subscribed.
AOSP	11	~3	~79%	Under-subscribed, not over — accepted most of what it received. Better served by outreach to attract more proposals than by a longer slot.

Recommendation. Hardware and Cloud & DevOps are the clearest candidates for a longer slot or a second parallel session next year — both estimated to reject roughly three-quarters of what they received, and Cloud & DevOps alone accounts for an estimated ~32 of the ~106 devroom-track rejects this method could classify. Security is a reasonable secondary candidate. AOSP is the opposite case: its high accept rate suggests it should spend 2027 recruiting more submissions before asking for more room. This is reinforced by this edition's reach data (if2026-summary.pdf, Section 12): Hardware and Cloud & DevOps are both capped at the same 120-seat room as AOSP today, so a longer slot or bigger room for either would relieve oversubscription and raise reach in the same move — the two problems have the same fix.

Of the 324 rejected submissions, an estimated 218 didn't match any devroom's vocabulary clearly enough to classify — most are likely General Track submissions (talks, lightning talks, BoFs, and panels reviewed directly by the Programme Committee), a separate rejection pool from the devroom-specific one analysed here.

3. Venue math for folding workshops into the conference days

This assumes a new venue for 2027 — not the same building as 2026. This edition widens the sizing assumptions considerably: devroom rooms can now be anywhere from 50 to 250 seats (previously fixed at 120 or 250), workshops 35–60 (previously 35–50), and BoFs 35–60 (previously fixed at 35) — and, for the first time, the General Track's own room sizes are left open ("suggest right size?") rather than assumed to match this year's Hall 1 / Hall 2. Two new fixed inputs also apply for 2027: community booths capped at 100 (up from this year's 75) and sponsors capped at 15, each receiving 15 passes (a new, explicitly-sized category that wasn't broken out separately from the attendee total this year). This year's reach data (if2026-summary.pdf, Section 12) is the starting point for sizing every room type below, not just a reference point: General Track in the two largest rooms (19 sessions at 840 seats, 25 at 250), all 8 devrooms uniformly capped at 120 seats regardless of depth or demand (75 sessions), 11 BoFs in 35-seat rooms, and 8 workshops in a separate pre-conference venue at 35–40 seats each. Folding workshops into the two conference days, differentiating devroom room sizes by actual demand instead of a flat cap, and adding a third BoF room, are the three structural changes this year's data argues for.

Suggested room sizes, by track type

General Track (suggest right size?). The General Track today runs in Hall 1 (840) and Hall 2 (250) for every slot, but no single slot needs to seat the whole conference at once — devrooms, BoFs and (from 2027) workshops run in parallel, pulling a share of attendees away from the General Track room at any given moment. Sized against the attendance estimate below (~3,105 projected total attendance, all categories) rather than copied from this year's building, a primary hall around **950 seats** (roughly 30% of projected attendance — enough for a well-attended opening/closing keynote or a popular General Track headline talk, without over-building) and a secondary hall around **300 seats** for the next-most-popular concurrent session are the recommended targets — both modest increases over this year's 840/250, in proportion to the attendance growth assumed below, not a step-change.

Devrooms (now 50–250, was fixed at 120/250). This year's reach data (Section 12) showed every devroom stuck at the same 120-seat ceiling regardless of oversubscription; Section 2's accept-rate analysis gives a principled way to differentiate now that the range allows it:

Devroom	Suggested 2027 capacity	Why
Hardware	250	~23% estimated acceptance rate this year — the strongest case for the top of the range.
Cloud & DevOps	250	~24% estimated acceptance rate and the most estimated submissions of any devroom.
Security	150	~32% estimated acceptance rate — real oversubscription, now also addressed with a full-day slot below.
Compilers	120	~52% estimated acceptance rate — this year's size looks about right.
Documentation & Technical Writing	120	~52% estimated acceptance rate — about right.
RTOS	120	~56% estimated acceptance rate, comfortably subscribed — its gap is the missing workshop (Section 1), not room size.
Design	80	~64% estimated acceptance rate, comfortably subscribed — room to shrink toward the new floor.
AOSP	80	~79% estimated acceptance rate, under-subscribed rather than over — needs outreach, not room; shrinking it frees venue budget for Hardware/Cloud & DevOps.

This edition also lifts the earlier assumption that devrooms are limited to 2 rooms running in parallel — "we can have more rooms to run devrooms too" — and, new this pass, spells out explicitly that a devroom "could occupy [a] half day, or full day slot" rather than always the single half-day block this year's schedule used. That changes the recommendation materially: rather than only differentiating room size, a third devroom room plus the option of a full-day slot lets this report answer Section 2's own question — "should any devroom get a longer slot?" — architecturally instead of just aspirationally. With 3 devroom rooms across 4 macro-slots (12 devroom-room-slots available), a full-day slot costs 2 of those 12 instead of the usual 1: giving all three of this year's most oversubscribed devrooms — Hardware (~23% acceptance), Cloud & DevOps (~24%), and now also Security (~32%, the next-tightest and the case this edition's spare capacity newly affords) — a full-day slot each uses $3 \times 2 = 6$ slots; the remaining five comfortably-subscribed devrooms

(Compilers, Documentation & Technical Writing, RTOS, Design, AOSP) keep a half-day slot each, using 5 more — 11 of 12 available slots, with 1 spare for scheduling flexibility. The three rooms: one at 250 seats (Hardware and Cloud & DevOps, each full-day), one at 150 (Security, also full-day), and one at 80–120 (rotating the five half-day devrooms).

Workshops (now 35–60, was 35–50) — a default of **45 seats** per workshop room is a reasonable planning midpoint, up from this year's 35–40, giving the newly-recruited devroom- and booth-sourced workshops (Section 1) a bit more headroom than this year's pre-conference-day rooms allowed. **BoFs (now 35–60, was fixed at 35)** — keep the first two rooms at 35 seats (matches this year's demand) and size the new third room, added to absorb the roughly tripled volume from Section 1d, at **60 seats**, since a producer-run town-hall-style BoF plausibly draws a bigger crowd than this year's smaller, single-organiser BoFs did.

The slot structure

Two days, each with a morning and a post-lunch session, gives 4 macro-slots total. Folding workshops in means every workshop occupies one full macro-slot in a 35–60 seat room, the same pattern devrooms already use (each devroom normally occupies one half-day, one-macro-slot block — except Hardware, Cloud & DevOps and Security, which this edition gives a full-day, two-macro-slot block each, per the longer-slot case above). Devroom room count grows from 2 to 3 this edition, specifically to carry that full-day capacity; every other track type's room count is unchanged.

Track type	Rooms needed	Seat size	Notes
General Track	2	~300–950	Suggested sizing above: ~950-seat primary hall, ~300-seat secondary hall, scaled to projected 2027 attendance rather than copied from this year's building.
Devrooms	3	~80–250	Up from 2 this edition — both "more rooms to run devrooms" and full-day (vs. half-day) devroom slots are now explicitly allowed. The extra room and full-day option together let Hardware, Cloud & DevOps and Security each run a doubled (2-macro-slot) session instead of just a bigger room in the same single slot.
BoFs	3	35–60	2 at 35 as before, plus 1 new room at 60 to absorb the roughly tripled volume from encouraging producer-run BoFs (Section 1d: ~20 candidates against this year's 11 accepted).
Workshops — Pilot (8 devroom-sourced only)	2	~45	$8 \div 4$ macro-slots = 2 parallel. Just Section 1a.
Workshops — Realistic (+14 already-submitted)	6	~45	$22 \div 4 \approx 6$ parallel. Section 1a + the real, already-written 1c proposals — no new pitching required.
Workshops — Full ambition (~40)	10	~45	All of 1a + 1b + 1c (minus overlaps) $\div 4 \approx 10$ parallel.

The bottom line — three tiers, pick one.

- **Pilot** (8 devroom-sourced workshops only, plus the extra BoF room from 1d): 10 rooms total — 2 general + 3 devroom + 3 BoF + 2 workshop. Directly fixes the "deepest devrooms get zero hands-on time" finding with the smallest possible venue ask, and by putting workshops in the same building as the main days, raises workshop reach from this year's 35–40 seats to the suggested ~45-seat rooms.
- **Realistic** (pilot + the 14 workshops already written and rejected this year, Section 1c): 14 rooms total — same 8 for General/Devroom/BoF, plus 6 workshop rooms. This tier needs no new outreach at all — every one of those 22 workshops already has an author who volunteered.
- **Full ambition** (everything in Section 1, roughly 40 workshops once overlaps are removed): 18 rooms total — the same 8 plus 10 workshop rooms, running in every one of the 4 macro-slots. This is the honest ceiling on what a two-day, four-slot structure can hold; going further would mean either more days or fewer parallel workshops per slot.

All three tiers assume workshops distribute evenly across the 4 macro-slots. In practice, some slots (e.g. the last one before closing) typically see lower attendance and demand — worth weighting the schedule so the busiest workshops don't compete for the same slot as the closing keynote or GB elections. It's also worth deciding whether differentiating devroom sizes (as recommended above) is worth the added venue complexity of building two different room sizes, versus

accepting that some devrooms will structurally always reach fewer people per session than others and treating a longer slot (more sessions, Section 2) as the primary lever instead.

Estimated 2027 attendance, all categories included

This year's own documentation now confirms something the previous edition of this report could only guess at: IndiaFOSS's 2,401 total registrations split cleanly into 1,641 **purchased tickets** (the five paid tiers) and 760 **reserved free tickets** for speakers, volunteers, sponsors, booth staff and a separate diversity-scholarship pool — two non-overlapping categories, not one total with producers folded invisibly inside it. That resolves the double-counting risk this section previously had to hedge around: a 2027 estimate can now be built as purchased tickets *plus* a properly-sized reserved pool, without guessing whether the two overlap.

Category	2026 actual	2027 estimate	Basis
Purchased tickets (5 paid tiers)	1,641	~1,970	+20% YoY growth assumed on the purchased-ticket base specifically (not the headline total, which also contains non-ticketed reserved passes) — a planning judgement call, not a measured trend, roughly consistent with the venue and room-count growth this section already recommends.
— of which: speakers	157	~210	Scaled with the projected +35% growth in total session count (138 → ~186: +23 from Section 1's workshop/BoF growth at the Realistic tier, plus +25 from giving Hardware, Cloud & DevOps and Security each a full-day rather than half-day slot, Section 3), at this year's ratio of unique speakers to sessions. Drawn from the reserved pool, not purchased tickets.
— of which: booth representatives	150 (75 booths × 2)	200 (100 booths × 2)	Directly from this edition's stated cap of 100 booths, at the same 2-representatives-per-booth staffing model as this year. Reserved-pool category.
— of which: sponsor passes	not separately confirmed, presumably part of this year's 760 reserved pool	225 (15 sponsors × 15)	Directly from this edition's stated cap: 15 sponsors, 15 passes each — the first time this category has an explicit number. Reserved-pool category.
— of which: volunteers & diversity scholars	~453 (760 reserved – 307 known speakers/booth reps)	~500	No explicit 2027 cap given for this remainder; assumed a modest +10% alongside overall event growth, since it isn't driven by the room-capacity changes the way booths/sponsors are.
Reserved pool subtotal	760	~1,135	210 + 200 + 225 + 500
Total, all categories	2,401	~3,105	Purchased tickets (~1,970) + reserved pool (~1,135), no double-counting between the two.

~3,105 is this report's single planning estimate for total 2027 attendance across all categories — a genuine improvement over the previous edition's hedged ~2,850–~3,470 range, now that the purchased/reserved split removes the overlap ambiguity that range existed to cover. The two soft spots left in this number are both on the growth-assumption side, not the counting-method side: the +20% purchased-ticket growth and the +10% volunteer/ diversity-scholar growth are both judgement calls with only one prior year of data to anchor them, so treat ~3,105 as the centre of a plausible band (roughly 2,900–3,300) rather than a precise forecast, while trusting the underlying arithmetic (which categories add up to which total) more than before.

4. Communities worth inviting for 2027

These are informed suggestions grounded in this year's data and general knowledge of India's FOSS landscape — not confirmed commitments. Each should be validated with the named organisation before being counted on.

4a. Communities that map directly onto this year's rejected devroom pitches

Rejected pitch	Communities to approach	Why
Building with Open Data in India	DataMeet, plus this year's Data For India / Open Data Kerala / OpenCity / Samaajdata booths	DataMeet already runs recurring civic-data meetups nationally; the booths give a ready-made speaker bench.
Tech Geopolitics and Policy	Internet Freedom Foundation, Centre for Internet & Society, plus this year's SFLC.in booth	All three are established Indian digital-policy organisations with conference-ready speakers.
Open Cellular Communication	India-based Open RAN / OpenAirInterface contributors, Free Software Community telecom groups	Fills the one genuinely unaddressed technical gap — no booth or session this year touched telecom infrastructure.
FOSS at the Edge of Experience	Processing/p5.js India community, Godot India meetup groups	Creative-coding and open game-dev communities exist in India but weren't represented this year.

4b. Established communities that could run a devroom as a mini-conference

- **SciPy India** — already a booth; running their own annual conference, a natural "Scientific Computing" devroom.
- **FOSS4G.IN** — already a booth; mirrors the global FOSS4G geospatial conference format, and overlaps with this year's OpenStreetMap content.
- **PyCon India organisers** — a dedicated Python devroom, distinct from the general software content already in the General Track.
- **Rust India meetup groups** — this year had scattered Rust content (an HDL talk, a Stable AIDL talk) with no dedicated home.
- **CNCF India chapters** — could formalise or co-run the Cloud & DevOps devroom alongside Point Blank.
- **GNOME Asia community** — a desktop-specific devroom, complementing this year's one-off GTK/Bézier-curves talk.

4c. Digital commons & Wikimedia-adjacent overlap

- **Wikimedia India / CIS-A2K** (Centre for Internet & Society's Access to Knowledge programme) — broader national Wikimedia presence, beyond this year's regional Kerala chapter booth.
- **ICFOSS** (International Centre for Free and Open Source Software, a Kerala government body) — notable given how South-India-concentrated this year's attendance already is (73% from five southern states, by the dashboard's own regional breakdown); ICFOSS's government-FOSS and Malayalam-computing work is a natural fit.
- **Open Knowledge India** — open-data and open-culture overlap with several of this year's booths.
- **Free Software Movement of India chapters outside Kerala/Karnataka** — a deliberate lever against the regional concentration finding, if the goal is a more pan-India draw.